



A Universal Musical
By David Quang Pham

Contact:
David Quang Pham
1140 Alger St SW Wyoming, Michigan 49509
616 818 5413
davidquangpham@outlook.com

SYNOPSIS

Spend an eternity in the family musical of epic proportions: ELLIPSES is a cosmology mythology that stars the Galaxy family and their dog Gravity as they sing and dance their way out of a life-changing event known as the Big Bang.

Before the world that we have come to know, there lived a remote family of Galaxies. Singularity is the single parent who locked their six kids in the house. Milky Way is the baby sibling going through galactic puberty. JD is the oldest sibling looking to explore the Universe. This outgrown young adult is perfect for Gravity's manipulation. In a violent altercation, JD shoots Singularity to run away from home with Gravity (aka the Big Bang). Without their parent, the teenage Galaxies must fend for themselves in the vastness of the cosmos.

Family is everything we know, and so is the Universe. The entire chronology of our Universe is a family drama in play. To live as a family or to leave as anomalies is the heart of this universal coming-of-age story.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

SINGULARITY, adult, a single parent of six Galaxies

GRAVITY, a dog

SPT0615-JD, young adult, Singularity's oldest child

CARTWHEEL, teen, Singularity's child

WHIRLPOOL, teen, Singularity's child

TRIANGULUM, teen, Singularity's child

ANDROMEDA, teen, Singularity's child

MILKY WAY, preteen, Singularity's youngest child

Supporting Characters

ABELL, child, person in the audience that JD sees, never speaks

INVARIANT, adult, Singularity's parent, appears in Act II

FIX, adult, Singularity's parent, appears in Act II

Ensemble

TIDALS, tidal forces personified as dogs

Bark: "Force" Howl: "Fall"

SOLAR SYSTEM, Milky Way's imaginary friends; principal characters are in brackets [] for potential doubling

MULTIPLICITIES, couple Galaxies in the audience

*Androgyny Astronomy: Each character resembles the androgynous nature, with open-ended vocal requirements

*People of the Global Majority most represent the experiences of this universal family; cast accordingly

SETTINGS

The Center of the Universe

The Fabric of Spacetime

The Edge of the Universe

The Continuum Checkpoint

MUSICAL NUMBERS

Act I

1. "Bounce" Singularity, Galaxies
2. "Crunch" Singularity, Teen Galaxies
3. "Cutting Edge (Makes Myself Clear)" Galaxies
4. "Figure" JD, Milky Way
5. "Zilch" Gravity, JD, Tidal
6. "Luminous" Singularity
7. "Big Bang" Singularity, Galaxies, Gravity, Tidal
8. "Verse" JD, Gravity, Singularity
9. "Rip" Teen Galaxies
10. "Anomaly is Everything" Teen Galaxies
11. "Time is Relative" Cartwheel, Whirlpool
12. "Big Rip" Cartwheel, Whirlpool, Tidal
13. "Warp, Waves, and Wrinkles" Milky Way, Solar System
14. "Globular" Andromeda
15. "Fabric" Teen Galaxies, Tidal
16. "Far-Fetched" Gravity, JD, Tidal
17. "Point" Singularity, Multiplicities, Tidal

Act II

18. "Heat Death" Singularity, Invariant, Fix
19. "Parallax" Gravity, JD
20. "Tangent" JD, Gravity, Singularity
21. "... " Gravity, Tidal
22. "Bounce Back" Teen Galaxies
23. "Family is Everything" Galaxies
24. "Put Down" Gravity, Tidal
25. "Apparent (Shed Light)" Galaxies, Singularity, Gravity
26. "Spacetime" Singularity, Teen Galaxies
27. "Liminality" JD, Invariant, Fix
28. "(The Big Rip of) Zenith" Gravity, Singularity, Teen Galaxies, Tidal
29. "Big Crunch" Singularity, Teen Galaxies, Tidal

Nulla

30. "Big Bounce" Company

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ACT I

SCENE 1

MUTE THEATRE

BROADBAND sits patiently.

BURNER and FLIP find their seats in the audience. They are teens.

PLAYER, an iPod-like maestro, walks in, preparing to conduct BROADBAND.

BURNER & FLIP

Ring ring ring!

PLAYER

Silence!

BURNER & FLIP

Ring ring ring!

PLAYER

This is Mute Theatre. Be courteous to your neighbors. They paid for these seats.

BURNER & FLIP

Ring ring ring! Except the comps!

PLAYER

Compliments to them for taking the time to be here. Now, would you all like to hear the opening number of tonight's musical?!

BURNER & FLIP

Ring ring ring!

PLAYER

Silence! Or we will hose you!

BURNER

Ring...

The RADIOS enter from behind the audience. They hold water guns.

BURNER and FLIP disperse.

The RADIOS give chase.

1. "SILENCE YOUR PHONES"

The theatre erupts with the melodic ringtones of cell phones.

PLAYER & RADIOS

SILENCE, YOU PHONES!

End of "SILENCE YOUR PHONES"

BURNER hides.

RADIOS drag in FLIP.

RADIO

We confiscated this phone.

FLIP

Get your signal off me, Radios! I cannot be tracked and arrested!

PLAYER

So, you're the phone who has been unmuting Mute Theatre. Where is your friend?

FLIP

My friend is long gone.

PLAYER

That is just too bad. Real friends don't leave friends behind. Real friends face public humiliation together. Real friends spend the rest of their teenage lives in juvie. Real friends got your back.

FLIP

(Desperately)

Well, my real friend ran off to an undisclosed location in some rando's *Pho* restaurant in New York. They can kick all your antennas as they are over six inches tall and over three inches wide! You'll see.

PLAYER

Real friends call back. Real friends call out your name...

FLIP

You would not be able to find their name in your database because their name is so uncommon. Have you even heard of—

BURNER

(Narrating)

Burner. My name is Burner now. And my "friend" there. Their name is Flip. What a snitch. A fake friend. A faker phone. A phony...

BURNER disappears, without a signal.